6.1.2. Utilizing the features of your application performance monitoring system

The data you can get from your application performance monitoring system helps you troubleshoot issues that you can trace back to your code changes. This connection allows you to tie your application performance to your development cycle. By utilizing the features of your APM system, you'll be able to make the connection between your product's performance and your development cycle much easier.

The tools we've looked at for analyzing arbitrary data can also be used for APM, but they require a lot of setup and maintenance. There are some production-ready tools that specialize in monitoring the performance of your application with minimal setup and a host of features. Two popular systems that fall into this category are New Relic (newrelic.com/) and Datadog (www.datadoghq.com).

Typical monitoring systems don't care about what your consumers are doing or examples like the previous one, but they do look at an awful lot of things relating to the health of the system. These allow you to monitor things like the following:

- Network connections
- CPU
- Memory usage
- Transactions
- Database connections
- Disk space
- Garbage collection
- Thread counts

New Relic is a hosted service that you can use for free if you don't mind losing your data every 24 hours. It has a great API so it's not so tough to pull out data you need to store and use the rest of it for alerting and real-time monitoring. New Relic also gives you the ability to instrument your